AI **AI-generated guide.** This guide was written entirely by the AI assistant Claude (Anthropic) and has not been edited by the ALITA team. Check it against the application; if something differs, the application is right.

ALITA – Getting started

OpenRouter key · guided tour · first steps · ALITA 3.12.0 · October 2026

ALITA turns research material – projects in all their versions, papers, notes, laws – into a knowledge map and a knowledge graph you can question. This page gets you from opening ALITA to your first answer in a few minutes.

1. What works without a key, and what needs one

Without an OpenRouter key	Needs your own OpenRouter API key
Look at the knowledge map, clusters, the 3D/time view	**Asking questions** in the Graph Chat (B) and the Document Chat (A)
Browse and open documents and their details	**Ask now** in the guided tour
Take the **guided tour** (reading the steps, putting example questions into the chat)	Uploading documents (summaries and embeddings)

ALITA has no shared key: **every user – reviewers too – brings their own key**. Questions are processed by the language model GPT-6 Luna through OpenRouter; each answer shows what it cost.

2. Get an OpenRouter API key (once)

1. **Create an account** at openrouter.ai (**Sign in** → Google, GitHub or e-mail).
2. **Add credit** at openrouter.ai/settings/credits. ALITA uses a paid model, so the key needs credit; a few euros last for many questions.
3. **Create a key** at openrouter.ai/settings/keys → **Create Key**, name it e.g. `ALITA`; a spending limit is a good idea. **Copy the key right away** – it starts with `sk-or-` and is shown only once.

Fees, payment methods and limits: User Manual → Get an OpenRouter API key.

3. Enter the key in ALITA

1. Paste the key into the field **OpenRouter API-Key** at the top and click **Save**.
2. The status next to it changes from **no key** to **Key …** with the last four characters.
3. The key stays **only in the memory of this page**. It is not stored on the server and is gone after a reload – paste it again then. Treat it like a password; if it leaks, delete it on OpenRouter and create a new one.

4. Take the guided tour

Click ▶ **Guided tour** in the header, next to the version number. The tour takes about ten minutes and walks through ALITA along the propositions of our research submission *"Explore or Exploit? An AI Research Memory Map that Makes Scholars' Epistemic Trajectories Observable and Contestable"*:

> Research is usually judged by its final version; the trajectory behind it – ideas proposed, tested, dropped and recombined across drafts – stays scattered and fades. ALITA makes this trajectory visible and contestable through three mechanisms: it **refreshes memory** (within a project and across projects), it

> **makes the argument traceable**, and it **supports updating one's schemes** – so that the choice between **exploring** a new path and **exploiting** the current one is made with the trajectory in view.

Step	What you see	Proposition
1	Welcome	the trajectory problem; the three mechanisms
2	The databases	what the collection contains (public: EU AI Act, Wachter)
3	The knowledge map	refresh memory: "where have we been?"
4	**Compare** EU AI Act ↔ Wachter	horizontal sense-making – beyond one's own research bubble
5	Ask about what the map shows	the map's links, followed through the ontology to the text
6	Version history of a law	vertical sense-making – a trajectory over versions
7	Papers → articles they discuss	traceability – explicit relations, not only similarity
8	The law's document details	the same relation, seen from the law
9	Let ALITA argue back	updating schemes – challenge a position, check the sources
10	Your own projects (with the password)	explored or exploited? knowledge stages of a project
11	Closing	explore or exploit; limits and what is planned

How to use it: Next / **Back** (or → / ←), **Esc** or ✕ to close. Steps with an example question offer **Put into Graph Chat** (inserts it; you press **Send**) and **Ask now** (sends it – needs your key). The tour switches pages and highlights the part of the screen it explains; you can click around in between. A link ending in `?tour=1` starts the tour on opening.

---

5. Everyday use in five points

1. **Pick the scope.** The database bar on top selects databases; a click on a cluster or project in the knowledge map narrows both chats to it. **Clear selection** widens the scope again.
2. **Choose the chat. B – Graph Chat** (B page) follows the connections: clusters, projects, people, methods, citations, laws. **A – Document Chat** (tab A/B) searches the text and is best for content and details.
3. **Ask in your own words**, in English or German. Name clusters ("C8 and C9"), articles ("Art. 31 AI Act") or a project.
4. **Check the sources.** Every statement cites numbered sources [n]; click a number to read the passage. The graph path under the answer shows how ALITA got there. ALITA's answers come from a language model and **can be wrong**.
5. **Open documents** in the tab **Documents** or by clicking them in the map: summary, methods, versions, citations, and for papers and laws the articles discussed.

Other databases (research projects) appear after entering the password next to the key field. Conversations stay only in this page; export them via **History** → ⇓ .txt before closing.